

Advanced Chama Management System

Troubleshooting Guide

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Version 1.0

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Troubleshooting Guide

Login Issues

"Invalid email, password, or group code"

1. Verify email is correct (check users.email)
2. Verify password is correct (reset in users.php if needed)
3. Verify group_code matches the user's record
4. Check users.status = 'active'
5. Check members.status = 'active' (if member_id is set)

"Account locked"

- Wait for lockout period to expire (configurable in Settings)
- Admin can reset attempts via database: `UPDATE users SET login_attempts = 0, locked_until = NULL WHERE email = ?`

"Account is suspended/inactive"

- Admin must change status in Users module

"Your registration is pending..." (various messages)

- Member status is not 'active' – check members.status
- Complete registration/verification/approval workflow

DataTables Issues

"Requested unknown parameter" warning

- Column count mismatch between <thead> and <tbody>
- Run in browser console: `dtHelper.validate('table')`
- Verify <tfoot> colspan matches if present

"Cannot reinitialise DataTable"

- Table already initialized. The `dtHelper.initAll()` skips initialized tables.
- If you need to force re-init: `dtHelper.init('#tableId')` (destroys first)

Missing buttons/sorting

- Check if no-sort class is on <th> for action columns
- Ensure dt-helper.js is loaded before main.js

Page Errors

PHP Notice/Warning

- Check XAMPP error log at C:\xampp\htdocs\chama-system\logs\error.log
- Common causes: undefined array keys, null values in queries

404 Not Found

Missing File	Status
fines.php	Not implemented
assets.php	Not implemented
data-export.php	Not implemented
help.php	Not implemented

500 Internal Server Error

- Check Apache error log
- Common: PHP parse error, database connection failure, missing file include

Database Issues

"Table doesn't exist"

- Run migrations/run_007.php and migrations/run_009.php to apply missing schema changes
- Verify database name in config/database.php

"Unknown column"

- Schema mismatch – run migration scripts
- Check AGENTS.md for recent schema changes

AJAX Issues

CSRF token mismatch

- Refresh the page
- Token is regenerated after each request – DOM is updated via JSON response
- Check that jsonResponse() includes csrf_token

405 Method Not Allowed

- AJAX endpoints are POST-only (contact.php, resend-verification.php)
- Use POST method, not GET

Browser-Specific

jQuery not defined

- Clear browser cache (old cached pages without jQuery in header)
- Verify views/layouts/header.php loads jQuery before inline scripts

Select2 not working

- Ensure jQuery is loaded first
- Check Select2 CSS/JS are loaded in header.php
- Verify select element has class select2 or is initialized in JS

SMTP / Email Issues

Emails not sending

1. Configure SMTP in Settings â†’ Email tab
2. Click "Test Email" to verify configuration
3. Check PHP error log for PHPMailer errors
4. Verify no firewall blocking outbound SMTP

Registration emails not received

- SMTP must be configured first
- Check spam folder
- Verify member email address is correct

Performance

Slow page loads

- DataTables with large datasets: use server-side processing (check serverSide option)
- Enable MySQL query caching
- Check for missing indexes on joined columns

High memory usage

- Increase PHP memory_limit in php.ini
- Reduce rows per page in DataTables (default: 25)